



Notification Waiver Determination

Ironbark – Paris Group

Acquisition	Invest Blue Finance Pty Ltd (Invest Blue), which is a wholly owned subsidiary of Ironbark Investment Partners Pty Ltd (Ironbark), applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of 100% of the shares in Paris Financial Holdings Pty Ltd (together with its subsidiaries, Paris Group), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	18 August 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Invest Blue, is a company limited by shares and a 100% subsidiary of Ironbark. Ironbark, Invest Blue, and their connected entities (together, Ironbark Group) provide financial advisory, wealth management, and aged care advisory services to individuals, Australian client households, family offices, high net worth clients, and institutional clients. A division of Ironbark Group provides funds management and trustee services, and certain specialised advisors engaged within Ironbark Group provide accounting and tax advisory services. The target, Paris Group, is a Melbourne-based financial services firm that primarily provides accounting and tax advisory services to small and medium sized enterprises and individuals. It also provides ancillary financial advisory and wealth management services.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application, and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular: a. there is limited horizontal overlap between the types of services offered by the parties, with Ironbark Group primarily supplying financial advice and wealth management services and Paris Group primarily supplying accounting and tax advisory services b. there are alternative providers of the types of professional services supplied by the parties in Melbourne and nationally.

	In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
--	--

**Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1)
of the Act**